2. Tenancy Reforms

Under this broader step, three inter-related reforms protecting the land tenants were effected:

(i) *Regulation of rent* so that a fixed and rational rate of rent could be paid by the share-croppers to the land owners;

(ii) *Security of tenure* so that a share-cropper could be feel secure about his future income and his economic security; and

(iii) *Ownership rights to tenants* so that the landless masses (i.e. the tenants, the share-croppers) could be transferred the final rights for the land they plough - *"land to the tillers"*.

3. Reorganisation of Agriculture

This step again has many inter-related and highly logical provisions in the direction of rational agrarian reforms:

(i) *Redistribution of land* among the landless poor masses after promulgating timely ***ceiling laws***—the move failed badly with few exceptions such as W. Bengal, Kerala and partially in Andhra Pradesh.

(ii) *Consolidation of land* could only succeed in the regions of the Green Revolution (i.e., Haryana, Punjab and Western Uttar Pradesh) and remained marred with many loopholes and corruption.

(iii) *Cooperative farming* which has a high socioeconomic moral base was only used by the big farmers to save their lands from the draconian ceiling laws.

The whole attempt of land reforms in India is considered a big failure by the majority of experts. Many consider the issue of land reforms in India as the most complex socioeconomic problem of human history[15]. The data regarding the numerical achievements of the land reforms have been highly discouraging[16].

(i) Tenancy reforms made tenants have their rights but only on 4 per cent of the total operated area of India (14.4 million hectares of operated area by the 11 million tenants by 1992);